

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1549

By Pearson

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend St. Jude Children's Research Hospital in Memphis for its groundbreaking leadership in HIV/AIDS treatment, research, prevention, and compassionate care for children, families, and communities.

WHEREAS, St. Jude Children's Research Hospital has stood for decades as a global leader in advancing care for catastrophic diseases affecting children, including pioneering efforts in the treatment and prevention of human immunodeficiency virus (HIV) and acquired immunodeficiency syndrome (AIDS); and

WHEREAS, in the earliest days of the HIV/AIDS epidemic in the 1980s, St. Jude made the moral and scientific commitment to confront this disease in children, establishing one of the nation's leading pediatric HIV research and care programs and helping transform HIV from a fatal diagnosis into a manageable chronic condition; and

WHEREAS, St. Jude is home to a nationally recognized Pediatric AIDS Clinical Trials Unit, designated a Center of Excellence, where children and youth gain access to cutting-edge therapies and clinical trials and where many of the medications now approved for pediatric HIV treatment were studied and advanced; and

WHEREAS, through its multidisciplinary HIV program, St. Jude provides comprehensive, lifelong care—combining antiretroviral therapy, mental health services, social support, and transitional care—ensuring that young people living with HIV can lead long, healthy, and dignified lives; and

WHEREAS, the hospital's Perinatal HIV Program has played a critical role in dramatically reducing mother-to-child transmission of HIV, helping achieve transmission rates of

less than one percent when proper medical care is provided, thereby protecting future generations; and

WHEREAS, St. Jude researchers and clinicians have contributed to groundbreaking advances in HIV science, including studies that shaped prevention strategies, improved drug therapies, and expanded access to long-acting and injectable treatments that reduce barriers to adherence; and

WHEREAS, through its leadership in national and international research networks, including NIH-supported trials and prevention initiatives, St. Jude continues to drive innovation in HIV treatment and prevention, ensuring that the most vulnerable populations are not left behind; and

WHEREAS, recognizing that health outcomes are shaped by more than medicine alone, St. Jude has led community-centered initiatives such as Connect 2 Protect and Operation Zero, working to eliminate new HIV infections in Memphis by 2030 through education, outreach, and collaboration; and

WHEREAS, in a region disproportionately impacted by HIV, particularly among young people, St. Jude has served as a one-stop center for testing, treatment, prevention, and education, reducing stigma and expanding access to lifesaving care; and

WHEREAS, the work of St. Jude embodies a commitment not only to scientific excellence but to justice, dignity, and the belief that every child, regardless of circumstance, deserves the opportunity to live a full and healthy life; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor and commend St. Jude Children's Research Hospital for its extraordinary leadership in the fight against HIV/AIDS and its enduring commitment to the health and future of children and families in Tennessee and around the world.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.